TEACHING STATEMENT

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> *"An understanding heart is everything in a teacher, and cannot be esteemed highly enough. One looks back with appreciation to the brilliant teachers, but with gratitude to those who touched our human feeling. The curriculum is so much necessary raw material, but warmth is the vital element for the growing plant and for the soul of the child."* (Carl Jung, 1875–1961)

During my college years (1997–2001) in Korea, I taught Korean, English, and Mathematics at a night school. The school was designed to provide free education for the disadvantaged. As these students were denied access to formal education, they were preparing for the GED college entrance exam. It was a great joy helping them learn something, seeing the progress they made, and making a difference in their lives. My experience as a volunteer teacher at a night school taught me a valuable lesson in life — the value of sharing. I do believe that this volunteer experience fundamentally motivated me to pursue my doctoral studies to become a professor. As a teaching fellow at the Olin Business School of Washington University in St. Louis, I had many opportunities to teach various undergraduate (BSBA) and graduate (MBA and MSF) courses, including both lecture-type classes and case-study classes.[1] Throughout my three years as a teaching fellow (2007–2010), I maintained close interactions with students by hosting help sessions and office hours on a weekly basis. In addition to the teaching fellow experience at the Olin Business School, my experience at The Bank of Korea as an economist (2011–2012) helped me to teach students how policymakers and/or practitioners apply academic theories in real world settings. Indeed, my interest in teaching deepened and I am confident that my experience in the central bank is a great asset for a teacher.

After joining the university education, in KAIST (2012–2023), I taught four MBA courses ("Corporate Valuation," "Mergers and Acquisitions," "International Finance," and "Business Strategies in Financial Service Industry") and a Ph.D. course ("Advanced Corporate Finance Theory"). In SNU (2023–present), I have taught two MA courses about the global economy and business environment ("Capital Markets and Financial Management" and "Corporate Business Analysis"). Based on my experience as a volunteer teacher at a night school, as a teaching fellow at the Olin Business School and as an economist at The Bank of Korea, I cultivated enthusiasm for sharing my knowledge with students. Moreover, I firmly established my own teaching philosophy with effective pedagogies, which I have successfully applied to classes in KAIST and SNU. Most of all, I strongly believe that a crucial element in the process of learning is motivation. I inspire my students with intellectual curiosity and a desire to understand the world using what we study in class. Utilizing business cases and the latest news articles related to the concepts we are studying is a good device to grab students' attention and to help them understand the dynamics of the real world. Requiring students to complete one or two challenging real-world team projects as homework or to do a take-home exam gives them a sense of achievement and a deeper understanding when they go through the process of solving a problem. To help students finish the project by themselves, I divide the problem into solvable sub-steps and give some hints for each step. As a result, the connections they make enable them to fully grasp the implications and importance of what they are learning and, therefore, acquire a better understanding of the real world cases.

[1] For the specific course titles, please refer to my vita.

Finance is essentially a discipline of quantitative analysis. The concepts look abstract to students, and it is difficult to get the gist of the logic when applying them to different situations. Practicing many problems by themselves is the very best way for students to understand the material and to develop analytical skills. In class, I provide regular assignments, as well as frequent help sessions for those assignments. By doing so, I can get to know what students do not understand and guide them to fully follow the pace of the class. Active interaction with students is another very important way to lead them. In addition to holding regular office hours for students, I maintain active contact with them via direct email communication so that they can reach me whenever they have questions about the course materials covered in class. In fact, in an advanced MA class "Corporate Business Analysis" (in SNU), I perceived that students found this communication channel particularly helpful and availed of it quite actively. Talking about my own research during lectures and office hours also encourages students to more directly interact with me. Indeed, I have received very positive feedbacks from students, who expressed gratitude that they could contact me freely; resolve all difficult problems under my guidance; and eventually structure/write their MA theses for themselves.[2] My teaching evaluation scores in KAIST and SNU are listed in the last page of this statement.[3]

Teaching students is not only enjoyable but also very rewarding. My biggest concern in classroom is ensuring that students feel comfortable in learning the materials, asking questions, expressing their own ideas, and communicating with their classmates. I have tried to create an environment that would be conducive to efficient and productive teaching and learning, strongly encouraging students to behave in a civil and thoughtful way and to respect others' opinions. As a teacher, I look forward to continuing to share my life's passion with students and to helping them develop a comprehensive understanding of the ways the economy affects our lives.

[2] In KAIST College of Business in June 2020, I also got awarded for excellence in education.

[3] The department's average scores are in the parentheses.

Average Teaching Evaluation Scores

Semester	Course	# of Enrolled Students	Scores
KAIST College of Business (Fall 2012 - Spring 2023)			
Fall 2012	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661E]	31	4.18/5.00 (4.07)
Spring 2013	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BA731]	17	4.75/5.00 (4.45)
Fall 2013	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661E]	55	4.26/5.00 (4.23)
Fall 2013	Mergers and Acquisitions [FIN627E]	27	4.47/5.00 (3.89)
Spring 2014	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	25	4.39/5.00 (4.10)
Fall 2014	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661E]	50	4.47/5.00 (4.27)
Spring 2015	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BA731]	15	4.65/5.00 (4.43)
Fall 2015	Corporate Valuation [FMB601E]	63	4.48/5.00 (4.27)
Fall 2015	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	63	4.62/5.00 (4.28)
Spring 2016	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661E]	38	4.53/5.00 (4.37)
Spring 2016	Mergers and Acquisitions [PMB661]	37	4.54/5.00 (3.74)
Fall 2017	Corporate Valuation [FMB601E]	67	4.65/5.00 (4.31)
Fall 2017	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	44	4.69/5.00 (4.34)
Fall 2017	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661]	29	4.36/5.00 (4.38)
Spring 2018	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BA731]	14	4.30/5.00 (4.38)
Spring 2018	Mergers and Acquisitions [PMB661]	28	4.55/5.00 (4.45)
Fall 2018	Corporate Valuation [FMB601E]	69	4.66/5.00 (4.36)
Fall 2018	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	57	4.67/5.00 (4.33)
Spring 2019	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BA731]	11	4.70/5.00 (4.46)
Spring 2019	Mergers and Acquisitions [PMB661]	47	4.49/5.00 (4.34)
Fall 2019	Corporate Valuation [FMB601E]	57	4.79/5.00 (4.36)
Fall 2019	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	47	4.74/5.00 (4.42)
Fall 2019	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661A]	23	4.89/5.00 (4.39)
Spring 2020	Mergers and Acquisitions [PMB661]	48	4.59/5.00 (4.27)
Fall 2020	Corporate Valuation [FMB601E]	44	4.84/5.00 (4.08)
Fall 2020	Mergers and Acquisitions [FMB612E]	37	4.71/5.00 (4.26)
Fall 2020	Mergers and Acquisitions [MGT661A]	34	4.82/5.00 (4.40)
Spring 2021	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BME731]	11	4.50/5.00 (4.37)
Fall 2022	Mergers and Acquisitions [BAF608E]	52	4.79/5.00 (4.35)
Fall 2022	Mergers and Acquisitions [BAF608X]	32	4.13/5.00 (4.24)
Fall 2022	FinTech M&A [BAF677D]	58	4.40/5.00 (4.15)
Spring 2023	Advanced Corporate Finance Theory [BME731]	8	4.29/5.00 (4.59)
Spring 2023	International Finance [BAF621]	66	4.63/5.00 (4.34)
Spring 2023	Business Strategies in Financial Service Industry [BAF620]	56	4.71/5.00 (4.34)
SNU Graduate School of International Studies (Fall 2023 - Present)			
Fall 2023	Corporate Business Analysis [8751.620]	26	4.54/5.00 (4.50)
Spring 2024	Capital Markets and Financial Management [8751.620]	28	4.68/5.00 (4.59)
Fall 2024	Capital Markets and Financial Management [M2050.001600]	23	4.50/5.00 (4.59)
Fall 2024	Corporate Business Analysis [M2050.001700]	9	5.00/5.00 (4.59)
Spring 2025	Capital Markets and Financial Management [M2050.001600]	26	4.76/5.00 (4.62)
Spring 2025	Corporate Business Analysis [M2050.001700]	10	4.86/5.00 (4.62)
Fall 2025	Corporate Business Analysis [M2050.001700]	23	4.85/5.00 (4.69)
Spring 2026	Capital Markets and Financial Management [M2050.001600]	32	4.86/5.00 (4.70)
Spring 2026	Corporate Business Analysis [M2050.001700]	11	4.83/5.00 (4.70)